MIHALY KOCZIHA

CONTACT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned data and consulting executive with over 17 years of experience driving digital transformation and innovation across financial services and other industries. With a proven track record in building high-performing teams and developing tailored strategies, I specialize in integrating data, AI, and banking solutions to empower organizations with actionable insights and competitive advantage. Adept at transforming complex business challenges into scalable, technology-driven solutions, I excel in leadership roles—whether as Head of Data or Head of Consulting—ensuring excellence in strategic execution and stakeholder collaboration.

🌐 **Strategic Data Leadership:** Led cross-functional teams, set clear objectives, and delivered high-quality data solutions on time and within budget.
📊 **Business Intelligence:** Skilled in BI tools (e.g., Power BI) to drive data-driven decisions across diverse departments.
🏗️ **Data Architecture:** Built scalable, efficient architectures that underpin robust data solutions.
☁️ **Cloud & Modern Tech:** Specialized in Azure (Synapse, Data Factory, Databricks) for migrations, analytics, and secure, scalable data solutions.
🔬 **AI & ML Expertise:** Developed and deployed AI-driven solutions for enhanced efficiency and decision-making.
🛠️ **Technical Proficiency:** Deep experience in Microsoft SQL Server, Azure, Databricks, Synapse, Data Factory, Microsoft Fabric, ETL, and Data Warehousing.
🤝 **Stakeholder Collaboration:** Excel at translating complex needs into streamlined solutions, fostering alignment and cross-team synergy.
📈 **Process Optimization:** Applied Agile and DevOps to deliver transformative projects (e.g., EDW, cloud analytics).
🧭 **Consulting & Advisory:** Provided strategic guidance and hands-on consulting to financial services and other industries, aligning data initiatives with broader business goals.

SKILLS

Microsoft SQL Server • Azure • Databricks • Synapse • PowerBI • dbt • Python • C# • Data Factory • Microsoft Fabric • Data Architecture • Data Warehousing • ETL • DevOps • DataOps • Data modeling • Data governance • Agile • Scrum • People management • Project management • Dynamics 365 • CRM • Data visualization • Analytics • Data science • Machine learning • Data Analysis • Data Visualization • Business Analysis • Software development • AI • AI Driven Development

EXPERIENCE

Head of Consulting (Data, AI and Banking Solutions) ***2025 –***
SMP Solutions Zrt. *Budapest, Hungary*

Leading diverse teams across data projects, data warehousing, BI, and consulting—ranging from banking core system migrations and unified front-end solutions to AI applications and multi-industry data strategy—to drive digital transformation and deliver actionable insights.

- **Strategic Data Leadership:** Oversee end-to-end data initiatives—including data warehousing, BI, and data strategy—for clients in banking, healthcare, retail, sports, agriculture, and manufacturing.
- **Banking & Core System Migrations:** Direct a specialized team managing the migration of a major bank's core system, ensuring seamless data transfer, minimal downtime, and compliance with industry regulations.
- **Unified Front-End Solutions:** Lead a separate team responsible for developing and integrating unified front-end systems for a major bank, enhancing user experience and operational efficiency.
- **AI Innovation & Applications:** Supervise an AI-focused team delivering cutting-edge solutions, from predictive analytics to automation, supporting multiple industries' digital transformation goals.
- **Consulting & Advisory Services:** Guide a dedicated group of data strategy consultants and business analysts, advising clients on best practices, governance, and the roadmap for data-driven decision-making.
- **Banking Consultancy:** Oversee a large pool of consultants who provide specialized expertise in banking operations, regulatory compliance, and digital transformation.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Act as a key liaison between technical teams and C-level stakeholders, ensuring alignment of project objectives with broader business strategies.
- **Business Growth & Thought Leadership:** Contribute to business development by identifying new opportunities, shaping go-to-market strategies, and sharing industry insights through thought leadership and client workshops.

Head of Data & AI ***2022 –2024***
SMP Solutions Zrt. *Budapest, Hungary*

As the founder and leader of the Data Management Division at SMP Solutions Zrt., I've built a high-performing team from the ground up and have spearheaded the implementation of strategic data architecture frameworks, cloud migrations, and analytics solutions that have markedly improved software delivery, reduced infrastructure costs, and boosted data-driven decision-making for our key clients in the banking and manufacturing sectors.

- **Division Establishment:** Founded and currently lead the Data Management Division, growing it from scratch to a high-performing team of data analysts, engineers, and scientists servicing major clients in the banking and manufacturing sectors.
- **Strategic Framework:** Designed and established a robust data architecture framework that sped up software delivery times by 35% across all client projects. Cloud Migration: Headed multiple cloud migration projects for big banks, streamlining data accessibility and reducing infrastructure costs by 25%. Enterprise Data Warehousing: Led the implementation of Enterprise Data Warehouses for a bank, to provide foundations for their group level projects.
- **CRM Implementations:** Oversaw CRM implementation projects, resulting in a 20% improvement in customer relationship management metrics across client companies.

- **Cloud Analytics Solutions:** Implemented cloud-based analytics solutions, enabling real-time data analytics, and boosting data-driven decision-making by 30% for our clients.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Act as a primary liaison between the Data Management Division and client stakeholders, ensuring alignment with broader business goals and strategies.
- **Executive Reporting:** Provide quarterly updates to executive leadership on project deliverables, milestones, and ROI, contributing to informed decision-making at the executive level.
- **AI Driven development:** Established a team of AI engineers to improve the internal software development processes by utilizing modern AI tools.
- **AI and Machine learning:** Established the AI development team of the company to deliver AI based software solutions to our customers.

Engineering Manager (Data & BI & Finance Systems) ***2017 - 2021***
Euronet Worldwide Inc. *Budapest, Hungary*

As an Engineering Manager of the Finance Systems Development organization at Euronet Worldwide, I built a team of 25+ professionals from scratch, orchestrated the creation of data-driven applications and BI solutions, initiated the company's move to Azure cloud services, and implemented automated payment and reporting systems that enhanced both finance and operational efficiency.

- **Organization Development:** Orchestrated hiring, training, and skill development initiatives, fostering a culture of excellence and collaboration within the team. Managed a team of 25+ professionals across multiple locations.
- **Data-Driven Solutions:** Led the development and implementation of data-driven applications and Business Intelligence (BI) solutions that enhanced finance and operations within the company.
- **Automated Payment System:** Designed and deployed a large-scale, automated payments and invoicing system that streamlined merchant settlement, reducing manual errors by 30% and speeding up payment cycles by 15%.
- **Financial Reporting:** Enabled more robust and real-time financial reporting by creating BI dashboards that offered key insights into operational and financial metrics.
- **Azure Cloud Initiative:** Pioneered the company's cloud adoption strategy by selectively migrating smaller applications to Azure, setting the stage for a broader cloud migration, and reducing operational costs by 10%.

Data engineering team lead ***2015 – 2017***
Euronet Worldwide Inc. *Budapest, Hungary*

As the Data Engineering Team Lead at Euronet Worldwide Inc., I managed a team of 8 professionals, overseeing the company's main Data Warehouse, initiating the roll-out of PowerBI for enhanced reporting, and implementing Agile methodologies and quality assurance checks to streamline project delivery and align data initiatives with overarching business goals.

- **Team Oversight:** Managed a diverse team of 8, including developers and support personnel, setting the groundwork for effective collaboration and high performance.
- **Task Assignment & Reviews:** Assigned tasks based on team members' strengths and project requirements, conducted regular performance reviews, and ensured understanding of requirements and architecture.
- **DWH Responsibility:** Took charge of managing the main Data Warehouse for the company, including schema design, data integration, and performance tuning. Reporting Functions:

Spearheaded the reporting functions, enabling efficient data extraction and more insightful business decisions across the organization.

- **Custom ETL Development:** Designed and implemented a bespoke ETL software specifically tailored for the company's main DWH, enhancing data processing efficiency by 25%.
- **PowerBI Rollout:** Led the introduction and adoption of PowerBI as the main reporting tool within the company, streamlining reporting and enhancing data visualization capabilities.
- **Methodology:** Instituted Agile practices into the team's workflow, increasing project delivery speed.
- **Stakeholder Collaboration:** Actively engaged with cross-functional teams to align data engineering initiatives with overarching business goals.
- **Quality Assurance:** Implemented robust QA checks to ensure the reliability and accuracy of data processes and reporting outputs.

Finance Systems Developer ***2013 - 2015***
Euronet Worldwide Inc. *Budapest, Hungary*

As a Finance Systems Developer at Euronet Worldwide Inc., I managed the development of data-driven applications on the MS SQL platform, owned changes to data models, and coordinated the deployment of multiple OLAP and ETL solutions, all while collaborating across departments to translate business needs into robust and efficient data architecture and Business Intelligence tools.

- **Data-Driven Applications:** Managed and executed the development of data- driven applications, utilizing the MS SQL platform to enhance finance and business intelligence capabilities.
- **BI Solutions:** Deployed various Business Intelligence solutions to assist in data- driven decision-making, effectively serving the analytical needs of the finance department.
- **Data Model Ownership:** Owned and managed all changes to data models, ensuring alignment with evolving business requirements and technological landscapes. Architecture and Design: Created comprehensive data models, solution designs, and data architecture to support both operational and analytical workloads.
- **OLAP Solutions:** Designed and built multiple Online Analytical Processing (OLAP) solutions to cater to the company's BI needs, enhancing data query performance and analytical capabilities.
- **Custom ETL Development:** Developed a custom ETL application to handle substantial data load requirements, improving data ingestion speed by over 20%. Project Coordination: Effectively coordinated between development needs, architectural considerations, and new solution implementation, ensuring seamless project executions.

Senior Business Intelligence Developer ***2012 - 2013***
Citibank International Plc. *Budapest, Hungary*

As a Senior Business Intelligence Developer at Citibank, I specialized in using SQL Server technologies like SSAS, SSIS, and SSRS to develop robust Business Intelligence solutions tailored for the Information Security department, ensuring high levels of data compliance and security in all implementations.

- **SQL Server Expertise:** Specialized in developing Business Intelligence and Data Warehouse solutions using SQL Server technologies such as SSAS (Analysis Services), SSIS (Integration Services), and SSRS (Reporting Services). Security-Centric Solutions: Focused on the Information Security sector, ensuring that all data solutions were compliant with the highest standards for data privacy and security.

- **SQL Server Technologies:** Employed the full suite of SQL Server tools (SSAS, SSIS, SSRS) to develop comprehensive BI solutions that improved data analytics capabilities in the Information Security area.
- **Cross-Functional Engagement:** Worked closely with the Information Security department to define requirements and deliver tailored BI solutions.
- **Compliance Alignment:** Ensured all BI solutions met stringent information security policies, thereby enhancing data integrity and compliance.

Senior Credit Risk Analyst ***2011 - 2012***
Citibank Greece *Athens, Greece*

As a Senior Credit Risk Analyst at Citibank Greece, I leveraged SQL Server and SAS platforms to develop automated reporting systems that not only improved the efficiency of the monthly reporting stack by 30% but also strengthened data integrity and compliance in the Credit Risk department.

- **Reporting Automation:** Developed automated SQL Server and SAS reporting solutions, transforming the monthly reporting stack of the Credit Risk department, and improving efficiency by 30%.
- **Credit Risk Focus:** Specialized in credit risk analysis, delivering key insights to assist in risk management and decision-making processes.
- **SQL Server & SAS:** Utilized SQL Server and SAS platforms to construct complex queries and generate comprehensive reports, thereby supporting the data needs of the Credit Risk department.
- **Automated Reporting:** Engineered reporting systems that minimized manual input, reducing error rates, and enhancing the timeliness of monthly reporting cycles. Data Integrity: Ensured that all reports complied with the stringent data accuracy and privacy regulations, fortifying the integrity of credit risk analyses.

Credit Risk Analyst ***2011 - 2012***
Citibank Hungary *Budapest, Hungary*

As a Credit Risk Analyst at Citibank Hungary, I specialized in retail credit and collections, leveraging SQL Server to develop automated reporting solutions and credit scorecards that enhanced data accuracy, facilitated more efficient risk assessment, and fostered interdisciplinary collaboration to deliver robust solutions.

- **SQL-Based Solutions:** Developed SQL Server-based reporting solutions aimed at enhancing retail Credit and Collections reporting, improving data accuracy and decision-making capabilities.
- **Retail Focus:** Specialized in the retail sector, providing valuable insights into customer credit behavior and collection patterns.
- **Scorecard Development:** Actively participated in the development of credit scorecards, thereby aiding in the creation of more accurate and efficient risk assessment models.
- **SQL Server:** Leveraged SQL Server to build complex queries and automate reporting, increasing the reliability and timeliness of credit and collections data. Interdisciplinary Engagement: Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including data scientists, financial analysts, and business stakeholders to refine reporting requirements and deliver robust solutions.

Project Manager ***2008 - 2011***
Citibank Hungary *Budapest, Hungary*

As a Project Manager at Citibank Hungary, I successfully led and executed a variety of retail banking projects, including the development of a credit card loyalty point tracking system, card operations reporting, and deceased customer management for credit cards, participated in the migration of the core system of the retail business.

- **Loyalty Point System:** Spearheaded the development and rollout of a credit card loyalty point tracking system, improving customer engagement and incentivizing spend.
- **Card Operations Reporting:** Led reporting initiatives related to card acquiring and transactions, facilitating more accurate tracking and analytics.
- **Deceased Customer Management:** Developed and implemented a comprehensive system for managing credit card accounts of deceased customers, ensuring compliance and sensitivity during the process.
- **System Migration:** Coordinated the testing phase for the core system migration in retail banking and card management, ensuring all functionalities met project specifications.

EDUCATION AND RECENT CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Business Administration and Management 2015 – 2018
Milton Friedman University
Budapest, Hungary

Certified Power BI Data Analyst 2022
Microsoft
Certified Azure Data Engineer 2022
Microsoft
Databricks Lakehouse Fundamentals 2022
Databricks